

01

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

James, Otto, Advaita, Radhakrishnan, sacred/holy, prayer/worship, public discourse and veridicality are CORE PAPER II.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Phenomenology–object–warrant separation, comparison and graded verdict are CORE ANSWER.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not fill answers with brain-region catalogues, mystical case lists or claims that ineffability makes experience unintelligible.

ANSWER LINE: [FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

02

Current scholarly anchor — [SUPPORTING]

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Fact: A 2025 Frontiers in Neuroscience review described neuroscience of religion as the study of correlations between brain functions and religious practices, beliefs and experiences, while emphasizing methodological and definitional limitations.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Inference: Neural mediation does not by itself prove either veridicality or illusion.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

It explains a mechanism or correlate; the philosophical question of the experience's object and warrant remains open.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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03

Visual gateway — ask three questions in order

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Recommended opening definition: Religious experience is an experience interpreted as disclosing or relating the subject to an ultimate, sacred or divine reality.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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Visual gateway — ask three questions in order

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MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Recommended opening definition: Mystical experience is a mode of religious experience marked, for William James, primarily by ineffability and noetic quality.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Core argument/criticism: Unlike episodic subject-object encounter, non-dual realisation claims to dissolve the distinction between knower and known and to become stable knowledge.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Equally, conceptual or neural mediation does not automatically make it fabricated.

ANSWER LINE: Master rule: A vivid or transformative experience can be psychologically real without its interpretation being automatically true.